Patient Handbook

Welcome to Bright Smile Dental. This handbook explains how our clinic works, what to expect at your visits, and the policies that keep appointments fair for every patient. Please read it before your first appointment.

Opening hours

The clinic is open Monday to Wednesday from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, Thursday from 9:00 AM to 7:00 PM, and Friday from 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM. We are closed on Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays. Our late Thursday hours are reserved first for school-age children and working patients.

Location and parking

We are located at 214 Maple Avenue, Suite 3, on the second floor above the pharmacy. Free patient parking is available in the rear lot for up to two hours. The entrance has a ramp and the building has an elevator, so the clinic is fully wheelchair accessible.

Contacting us

Call the front desk at (555) 014-2290 during opening hours. Outside opening hours our AI receptionist answers the phone, can book appointments and takes messages for the team. You can also email hello@brightsmile.example and we reply within one business day.

Your First Visit

New patients should arrive 15 minutes early to complete the medical history form. Please bring a photo ID, your insurance card, and a list of any medications you take. If you have dental X-rays from another clinic taken in the last 12 months, ask them to send the files to us before your visit.

A first visit takes about 60 minutes. It includes a full examination, a set of digital X-rays, a professional cleaning when time allows, and a treatment plan with prices explained before anything is done. We never start treatment you have not agreed to.

Children

We see children from age 2. A parent or legal guardian must stay in the clinic for patients under 16. We recommend a child's first check-up by their second birthday, and every six months after that. Children under 12 receive a free fluoride treatment at each check-up.

Anxious patients

Tell us if you feel nervous about dental treatment. We can book a longer appointment, explain each step before we do it, agree on a stop signal, and offer noise-cancelling headphones. Nitrous oxide (laughing gas) is available for an extra charge listed in our price list.

Appointments and Cancellations

You can book by phone, by email, or through our AI receptionist at any time. Routine check-ups are booked in 30-minute slots. Longer treatments such as crowns or root canals are booked in 60 to 90 minute slots.

Cancellation policy

Please give at least 24 hours' notice if you need to cancel or move an appointment. Cancellations with less than 24 hours' notice, and missed appointments, are charged a $40 late-cancellation fee. The fee is waived once per year, and always waived for genuine emergencies or illness.

Patients who miss three appointments in a 12-month period without notice may be asked to pay a deposit before booking further appointments.

Running late

If you arrive more than 15 minutes late we may need to shorten your appointment or rebook it, so the patients after you are not kept waiting. Call us if you know you will be late and we will do our best to fit you in.

Reminders

We send a text message reminder two days before every appointment and a second reminder on the morning of the visit. Reply C to confirm or R to ask us to reschedule.

Payments and Insurance

Payment is due at the end of each visit. We accept cash, debit and credit cards, Apple Pay and Google Pay. We do not accept personal cheques.

Insurance

We are in-network with Delta Dental, Cigna, MetLife and Aetna. For these plans we bill the insurer directly and you pay only your share on the day. For other insurers we provide an itemised receipt so you can claim the cost back yourself. Medicaid is not accepted at this clinic.

Payment plans

For treatment plans over $500 we offer interest-free payment plans over 3, 6 or 12 months. A payment plan needs a 20 percent deposit on the day treatment starts. Ask the front desk for the payment plan form.

Membership plan

Patients without insurance can join the Bright Smile Membership for $29 per month. It covers two check-ups and two cleanings per year, all routine X-rays, and gives 15 percent off any other treatment.

Emergencies

A dental emergency includes severe tooth pain, a knocked-out tooth, a broken tooth with sharp edges, or swelling in the gums or face. Call us as soon as possible. We keep two emergency slots open every weekday, one at 11:30 AM and one at 4:00 PM, for patients in pain.

Knocked-out tooth

If an adult tooth is knocked out, hold it by the crown, not the root. Rinse it gently without scrubbing and try to put it back in its socket. If that is not possible, keep it in milk and come to the clinic within one hour, because the chance of saving the tooth drops quickly after that.

When to go to hospital

If facial swelling makes it hard to breathe or swallow, or you have a high fever with dental pain, call 911 or go to the nearest emergency room straight away. Do not wait for a dental appointment.

After hours

Outside opening hours, call our main number. The AI receptionist will take an urgent message and the on-call dentist will call you back, usually within one hour, between 7:00 AM and 10:00 PM.

Privacy and Records

Your records are stored in an encrypted practice management system. Only clinical staff involved in your care and our billing team can access them. We never sell patient data.

Getting copies of your records

You can request a copy of your dental records, including X-rays, by email or in person. We provide digital copies free of charge within 10 business days. Printed copies cost $15 to cover printing.

How long we keep records

Adult patient records are kept for 10 years after your last visit. Records for children are kept until the patient turns 28. After that, records are securely destroyed.

Feedback and complaints

We want to hear about anything we could do better. Speak to the practice manager, Dana Ortiz, or email feedback@brightsmile.example. We acknowledge every complaint within 2 business days and aim to resolve it within 14 days.